

Skills Summary

Comparing Two Sets by Counting On

Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.

Skill 1 — Which Set Has More?

Rule: Count each set. The count that comes **later** in the counting sequence is the bigger one — that set has *more*. If the counts match, the sets have the *same* number.

Example: Set A counts to 5 and set B counts to 8. Which set has more?

Step 1. Compare the two counts by asking which one is said later when we count up.

Step 2. Counting goes “... 5, 6, 7, 8 ...” — 8 comes later, so B has more: $5 < 8$.

Try it: Set A counts to 9 and set B counts to 6. Write the comparison with $<$, $>$ or $=$.

check: $9 < 6$

(!) Watch out: A spread-out row can *look* bigger. Only the count decides — not how much space the dots take up.

Skill 2 — How Many More?

Rule: Start at the **smaller** count and count on up to the **bigger** count. The number of hops you make is *how many more*.

Example: One row has 4 dots and another has 7. How many more in the bigger row?

Step 1. Count on from the smaller count to the bigger one and keep track of the hops.

Step 2. From 4: “5, 6, 7” — that is 3 hops, so the bigger row has **3** more dots.

Try it: One frame shows 6 dots and a full frame shows 10. How many more in the full frame?

check: 4

Skill 3 — Making Two Sets Equal

Rule: To make the small set equal to the big one, count on from the small count to the big count. The hops tell how many to **add**.

Example: A has 3 stickers and B has 8. How many more stickers does A need to have the same as B?

Step 1. The hops from A’s count up to B’s count are exactly the stickers A is missing.

Step 2. From 3: “4, 5, 6, 7, 8” — 5 hops, so A needs **5** more stickers.

Try it: A has 2 blocks and B has 6. How many more blocks does A need?

check: 4